



Measles Frequently Asked Questions

Due to a rise in reported measles cases in the United States, we're receiving more questions about vaccination, immunity, and prevention.

(This FAQ is accessible via HealthConnect SmartPhrase .VMCMMRFAQ or .VMCMEASLESFAQ.) Here are answers to the most frequently asked questions.

Measles Vaccination Age

Should my child get the Measles, Mumps, and Rubella (MMR) vaccine early, before 12 months of age?

The CDC recommends that infants aged 6-11 months receive one dose of the MMR vaccine if they are traveling internationally or during a measles outbreak. However, this dose does not count toward the routine two-dose series, which should still be administered at 12-15 months and 4-6 years of age.

Currently, local, regional, and national experts have **NOT** recommended vaccinating children under 12 months old in our area.

Children are well-protected if caregivers and close contacts are immune to measles.



My child received one MMR at 12 months of age and is not due for the second MMR until 4 years old. Can we administer the second dose of MMR vaccine earlier than 4 years old?

Yes, the second dose of the MMR vaccine can be administered earlier than 4 years of age, if it is given at least 28 days after the first dose.

The CDC states, "Children 12 months of age and older should receive two doses of MMR vaccine, separated by at least 28 days" before any international travel.

Measles Vaccination and Travel

We're traveling to X country outside of the United States. Should we ensure measles immunity before traveling there?

The CDC recommends ensuring measles immunity/vaccination before travel to ANY country outside of the United States.

How far in advance before international travel should we receive the MMR vaccine?

You should plan to be fully vaccinated against measles at least **2 weeks before you depart**. If your trip is less than 2 weeks away and you're not protected, you should still get a dose of MMR.

Checking Measles Immunity

How do I know if I am immune to measles?

According to our recent SCPMG Leadership Update:

- Written documentation of adequate vaccination:
 - 1 or more doses of attenuated live measles-containing vaccine administered on or after the first birthday for preschool-age children and adults who are NOT at high risk.
 - 2 doses of attenuated live measles-containing vaccine for school-age children and adults at high risk including college students, health care personnel, and international/domestic travelers.
- Laboratory evidence of immunity or confirmation of measles (positive Rubeola IgG). [MEASLES \(RUBEOLA\) IGG \[86765D\]](#)
- Birth before 1957.

Can you order blood tests for measles serology, or can I receive a booster of MMR vaccine?

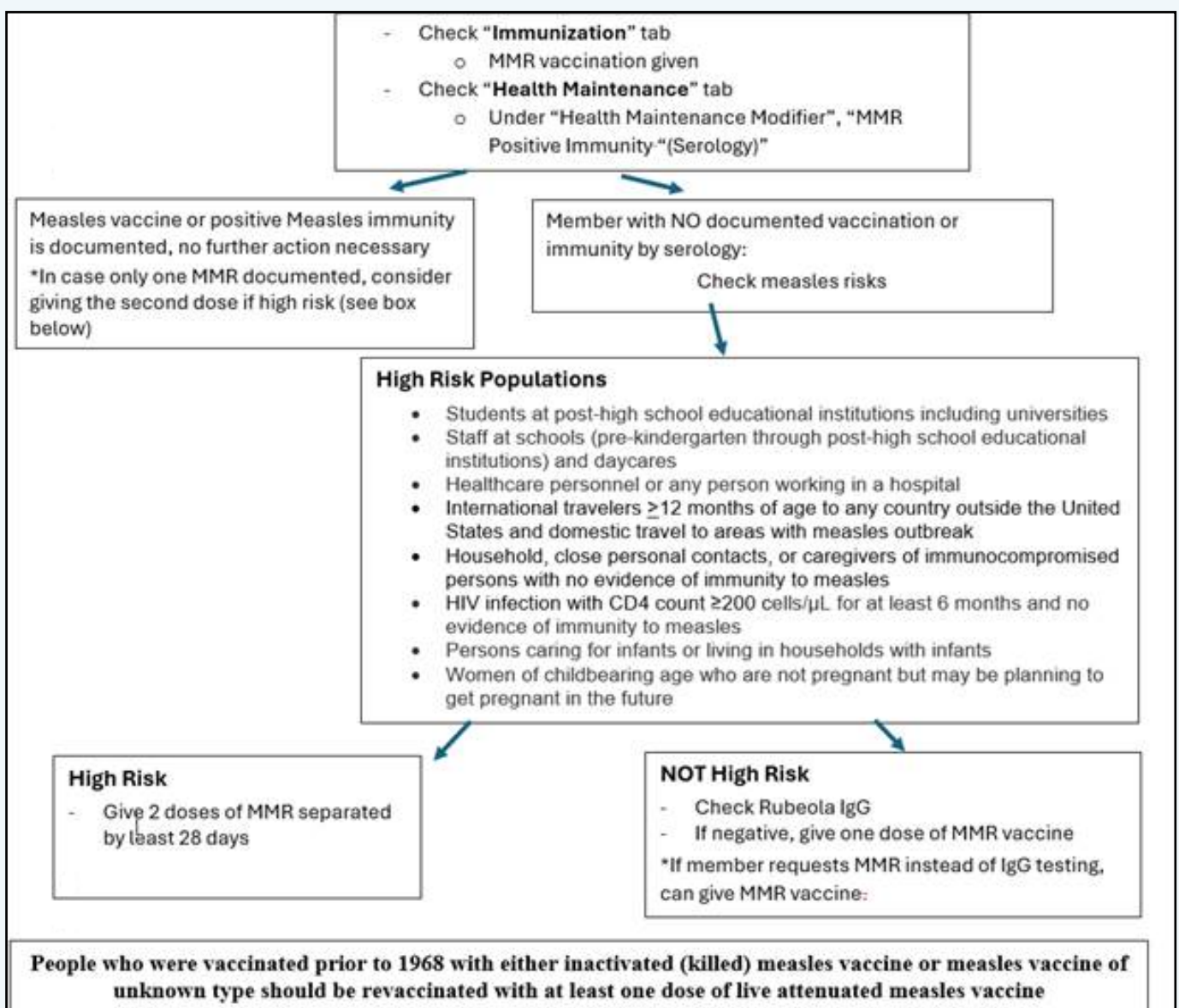
Checking a measles serology and/or offering a booster of MMR vaccine is NOT recommended if the patient is born before 1957, is fully vaccinated or has a previous positive measles (rubeola) IgG.

People who were vaccinated between 1963-1968 with either inactivated (killed) measles vaccine or measles vaccine of unknown type should be revaccinated with at least one dose of live attenuated measles vaccine.

I'm an adult patient. Can you check my immunization status?

Adults born before 1957 are considered immune (serology cohort studies showed immunity 95-98%).

If born after 1957, check your patient's measles immune status with the chart below.



References

Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (2024). Measles vaccine recommendations. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. <https://www.cdc.gov/measles/hcp/vaccine-considerations/index.html>

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Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (2024). Questions about measles. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. <https://www.cdc.gov/measles/about/questions.html>

Kaiser Permanente. (2025). SCPMG leadership update: 3/5/25. Kaiser Permanente.